INCH-POUND

A-A-20179A
May 31, 1996
SUPERSEDING
A-A-20179
October 18, 1981

COMMERCIAL ITEM DESCRIPTION

BROWNING AND SEASONING SAUCE

The U.S. Department of Agriculture has authorized the use of this Commercial Item Description.

1. SCOPE.

1.1 This Commercial Item Description (CID) covers browning and seasoning sauce, packed in commercially acceptable containers, suitable for use by the Federal Government.

2. CLASSIFICATION.

2.1 The browning and seasoning sauce shall conform to the following types which shall be specified, as required in the solicitation, contract, or purchase order.

Types.

Type I - Without hydrolyzed vegetable protein (HVP)
Type II - With HVP

3. SALIENT CHARACTERISTICS.

3.1 Use: The ready-to-use sauce may be used to accelerate browning of meats and poultry

Beneficial comments, recommendations, additions, deletions, clarifications, etc., and any data which may improve this document should be sent to: Head, Food Quality Assurance Staff, Fruit and Vegetable Division, Agricultural Marketing Service, U.S. Department of Agriculture, Room 2506, South Building, P.O. Box 96456, Washington, DC 20090-6456 or FAX (202) 690-0102.

FSC 8950

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during cooking, and to enhance the color (browning) and flavor of gravies, sauces, stews, soups, and casseroles.

3.2 Preparation and processing: The browning and seasoning sauce shall be prepared from food grade materials. The manufacturing process, in keeping with good commercial practice, shall preserve the product without impairing the quality and shall preclude microbiological spoilage.

3.3 Ingredients: The browning and seasoning sauce may contain caramel color, carmelized sugar, salt, celery, carrots, corn syrup, garlic, onions, parsley, parsnips, hydrolyzed soy protein, modified food starch, turnips, spices, vinegar, meat extracts, sulfiting agents, and other ingredients. Sodium benzoate may be added to preserve freshness.

3.4 Flavor and odor: The browning and seasoning sauce shall possess a well-blended, sweet, acid, mellow, vegetable/herb/spice flavor and aroma.

3.5 Color: The browning and seasoning sauce shall be a golden to dark brown liquid.

3.6 Finished product: The browning and seasoning sauce shall be a smooth suspension that flows freely at room temperature, does not stratify or separate, and is free from lumps.

3.7 Analytical requirements: Browning and seasoning sauce shall conform to the following analytical requirements:

	Type I (without HVP)	Type II (with HVP)
Soluble Solids	Greater than or equal to 52 Brix	Greater than or equal to 52 Brix
Sodium	0.10 to 3.70 percent	1.70 to 2.20 percent
pH	Less than or equal to 3.1	Greater than 3.1
Water Activity	Greater than 0.84	Less than or equal to 0.84

3.7.1 Analytical procedure: A composite of approximately 4 ounces (113.40 g) of browning and seasoning sauce shall be used for water activity testing. Excluding water activity, a composite of approximately 4 ounces (113.40 g) of browning and seasoning sauce shall be used for remaining analytical testing.

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3.7.2 Analytical testing: Analysis shall be made in accordance with the following Official Methods of Analysis of the AOAC International:

Test	Method
Soluble Solids	932.14A
Sodium	966.16
pH	981.12C
Water Activity	978.18B

3.7.3 Test results: The test results shall be reported to the nearest whole number for soluble solids, 0.1 percent for pH, and 0.01 percent for sodium and water activity. Any result not conforming to the analytical requirements, as indicated by USDA test results, shall be cause for rejection of the lot.

4. REGULATORY REQUIREMENTS.

4.1 The browning and seasoning sauce shall comply with all applicable Federal and State mandatory requirements and regulations relating to the preparation, packaging, labeling, storage, distribution, and sale of the browning and seasoning sauce within the commercial marketplace. Delivered browning and seasoning sauce shall comply with all applicable provisions of the Federal Food, Drug, and Cosmetic Act and regulations promulgated thereunder.

5. QUALITY ASSURANCE PROVISIONS.

5.1 Product conformance. The browning and seasoning sauce provided shall meet the salient characteristics of this CID, conform to the producer's own specifications, standards, and quality assurance practices, and be the same browning and seasoning sauce offered for sale in the commercial market. The Government reserves the right to require proof of such conformance.

5.2 Quality assurance. When required in the solicitation, contract, or purchase order that product quality or acceptability or both be determined, the Processed Products Branch (PPB), Fruit and Vegetable Division, Agricultural Marketing Service, U.S. Department of Agriculture, shall be the certifying activity and shall make the determination in accordance with applicable PPB procedures. The browning and seasoning sauce shall be examined or analyzed or both in accordance with applicable provisions in this CID, solicitation, contract, or purchase order, and, when applicable, the United States Standards for Condition of Food Containers in effect on the date of the solicitation.

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6. PACKAGING.

6.1 Preservation, packaging, packing, labeling, and case marking. Preservation, packaging, packing, labeling, and case marking shall be specified in the solicitation, contract, or purchase order.

7. NOTES.

7.1 Sources of documents.

7.1.1 Source of information for nongovernmental documents is as follows:

Copies of the Official Methods of Analysis of the AOAC International may be obtained from: **AOAC International, 481 North Frederick Avenue, Suite 500, Gaithersburg, MD 20877.**

7.1.2 Sources of information for governmental documents are as follows:

Applicable provisions of the Federal Food, Drug, and Cosmetic Act are contained in 21 CFR Parts 1 to 199. This document may be purchased from: **Superintendent of Documents, ATTN: New Orders, P.O. Box 371954, Pittsburgh, PA 15250-7954.** Credit card (MasterCard or Visa) purchases may be made by calling the Superintendent of Documents on (202) 512-1800.

Copies of the United States Standards for Condition of Food Containers are available from: **Chairperson, Condition of Container Committee, Agricultural Marketing Service, U.S. Department of Agriculture, Room 2506, South Building, P.O. Box 96456, Washington, DC 20090-6456.**

Civil agencies and other interested parties may obtain copies of this CID from: **General Services Administration, Federal Supply Service Bureau, Specifications Section, Suite 8100, 470 L'Enfant Plaza, SW, Washington, DC 20407.**

Military activities should submit requests for copies of this CID to: **Standardization Documents Order Desk, Building 4, Section D, 700 Robbins Avenue, Philadelphia, PA 19111-5094.**

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MILITARY INTERESTS:

Military Coordinating Activity

Army - GL

Custodians

Army - GL
Navy - SA
Air Force - 35

Review Activities

Army - MD, QM
Navy - MC
DLA - SS

CIVIL AGENCY COORDINATING ACTIVITIES:

DOJ - BOP
HHS - NIH, IHS
USDA - FV
VA - OSS

PREPARING ACTIVITY:

USDA - FV

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